

Leadership

What is Leadership?

Leadership and management are often confused. What's the difference? John Kotter of the Harvard Business School argues that management is about coping (facing) with complexity. Good management brings about order and consistency by drawing up formal plans, structures and monitoring results against plans.

Leadership in contrast, is about coping with change. Leaders establish direction by developing a vision of future; then they align people by communicating this vision and inspiring them to overcome hurdles.

Leadership Definition

In simple words leader is someone who creates more leaders.

Leadership is the ability to influence a group toward the achievement of a vision or set of goals. The source of this influence may be formal, such as that provided by managerial rank in the organization.

Manager need to be a good leader. Organizations need strong leadership and management for optimal (proper) effectiveness (success).

Trait Theories of Leadership

The trait theory of leadership focuses on identifying different personality traits and characteristics that are linked to successful leadership across a variety of situations.

According to Carlyle, history is shaped by extraordinary leaders. This ability to lead is something that people are simply born with, Carlyle believed, and not something that could be developed. According to him:

- i. People are "born" with leadership traits.
- ii. Certain traits produce certain patterns of behavior.

Leadership Traits

While the list of leadership traits can vary by whoever is drawing up the list, According to the researchers, the traits most commonly associated with great leadership include:

- i. **Adaptability and flexibility:** Effective leaders don't get stuck in a rut (پرانہ رواج). They are able to think outside of the box and adapt quickly to changing situations.
- ii. **Assertiveness:** Assertiveness means quality of being self-assured and confident without being aggressive (جارجانہ). A great leader is able to be direct and assertive without coming off as overly pushy or aggressive.
- iii. **Capacity to motivate people:** A great leader knows how to inspire others and motivate them to do their best.
- iv. **Courage and resolution (عزم):** The best leaders are brave and committed to the goals of the group. They do not hide from challenges.
- v. **Creativity:** Perhaps most importantly, great leaders not only possess their own creativity, but they are also able to foster (promote) creativity among members of the group.
- vi. **Eagerness to accept responsibility:** Strong leaders take on responsibility and don't pass the blame on to others. They stand by their success and take ownership of their mistakes.
- vii. **Emotional stability:** In addition to being dependable overall, strong leaders are able to control their emotions and avoid overreactions
- viii. **Need for achievement:** Strong leaders have a need to succeed and help the group achieve goals. They genuinely care about the success of the group and are committed to helping the group reach these milestones.
- ix. **People skills:** Excellent interpersonal skills are essential for leading effectively. Great leaders know how to interact well with other leaders as well as with team members.

- x. **Perseverance** (ثابت قدمی): Strong leaders stick with it, even when things get difficult or the group faces significant obstacles.
- xi. **Self-confidence**: Many of the best leaders are extremely self-assured. Because they are confident in themselves, followers often begin to share this self-belief.
- xii. **Task competence**: A great leader is skilled and capable. Members of the group are able to look to the leader for an example of how things should be done.
- xiii. **Trustworthiness**: Group members need to be able to depend upon and trust the person leading them.

Behavioral Theories

The behavioral leadership theory focuses on how leaders behave, and assumes that these traits can be copied by other leaders. Sometimes called the style theory, it suggests that leaders aren't born successful, but can be created based on learnable behavior.

Behavioral leadership theory argues that the success of a leader is based on their behavior rather than their natural attributes. Behavioral leadership theory involves observing and evaluating a leader's actions and behaviors when they are responding to a specific situation.

This theory believes that leaders are made, not born. This theory suggest that anyone can become an effective leader if they can learn and implement certain behaviors.

This theory promotes the idea that all leaders are capable of learning and developing through adopting beneficial behaviors and performing them in their workplace.

Behavioral leadership theory also encourages leaders to be self-aware of their behavior and to recognize how it affects the productivity and morale of their team.

Types of behavioral leadership

There are several key styles of behavioral leadership. Each one involves a different set of behaviors and may be more or less effective in certain work environments:

i. People-Oriented Leaders

People-oriented leaders focus on behaviors that allow them to meet the needs of the people they interact with, including supervisors, employees and clients. People-oriented leaders build relationships with their team members to motivate them to perform well. This type of leader monitor team members, encourage collaboration etc.

ii. Task-Oriented Leaders

❑ Task-oriented leaders are primarily focused on setting goals and achieving objectives. They are typically more focused on their team's final results rather than the day-to-day developmental process. Behaviors that are common for a task-oriented leader include:

- **Initiating projects**
- **Organizing processes**
- **Clarifying instructions**
- **Gathering relevant data**

iii. Participative-Oriented Leaders

❑ Participative leaders make an effort to include their entire team in decision-making processes. They prioritize active communication, collaboration and

feedback. Participative leaders know their team's strengths and weaknesses and assign tasks accordingly. Participative leaders are likely to:

- **Facilitate team meetings**
- **Ask for constructive feedback**
- **Take suggestions for improvement**
- **Delegate tasks to other team members**

iv. Dictatorial Leaders

❑ Dictatorial leaders often value results more than they do people. They may pressure their team members to perform well even during stressful or challenging periods. Dictatorial leaders are often successful in delivering high-quality results but may experience high-turnover rates due to employee dissatisfaction and burnout. The behaviors of a dictatorial leader include:

- **Setting inflexible deadlines**
- **Ignoring feedback**
- **Achieving short-term goals**

v. Sound Leaders

❑ Sound leadership is considered the most effective type of behavioral leadership. However, it is typically difficult to practically implement. Sound leaders equally prioritize productivity and team morale. They value their team members, set achievable goals and deliver high-quality results. Sound leaders exhibit behaviors like:

- **Encouraging open communication**
- **Allowing employees to work independently**
- **Listening to and implementing feedback**
- **Providing training and continuing education to team members**